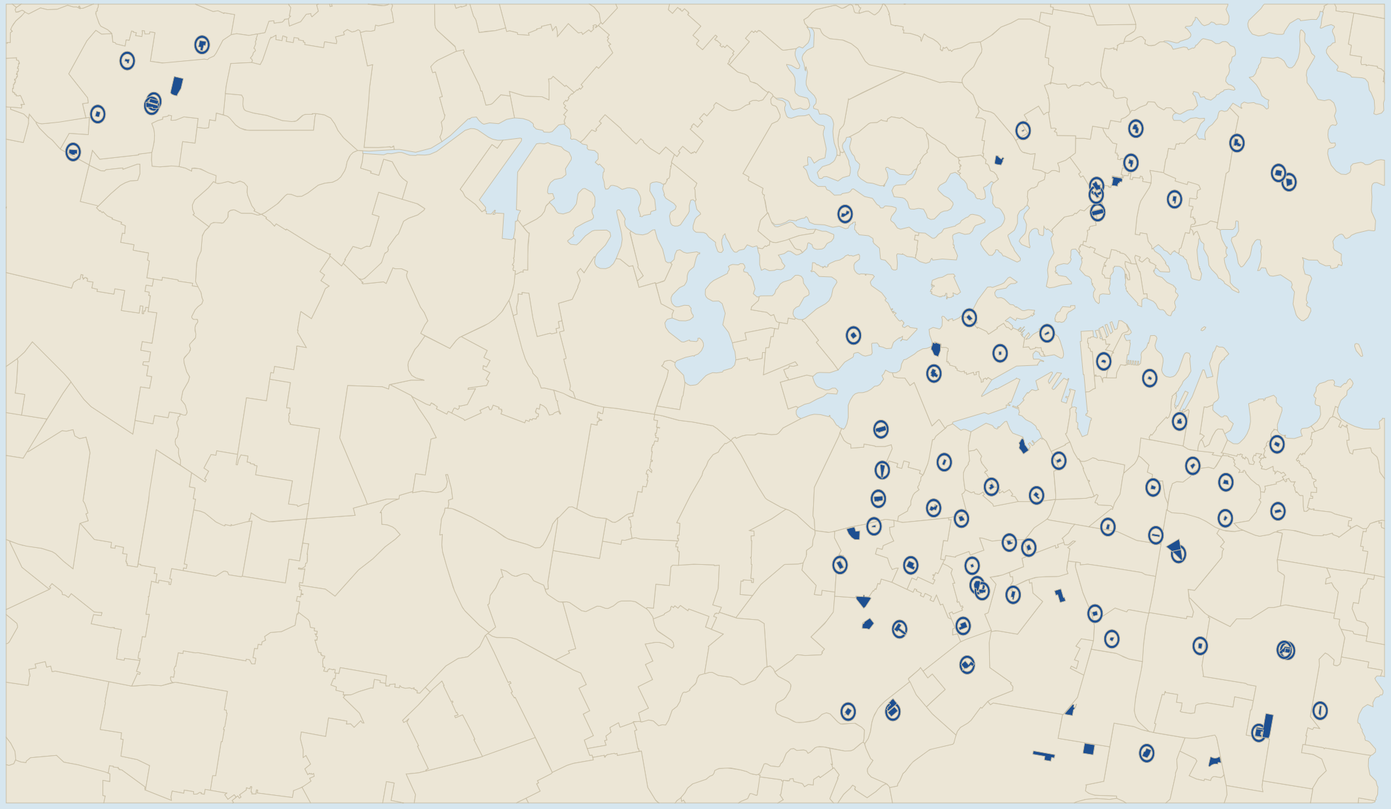
HOW MUCH GROUND DOES EACH STUDENT GET?

NSW government schools in inner Sydney and Parramatta. Grounds per student from the shapes made in Plotlay, for the year picked (2025 when none is).

Year

2025

m² of grounds per student (darker: less ground)



Median m² per student, all compared schools

30.7

Median m² per student, high schools

34.7

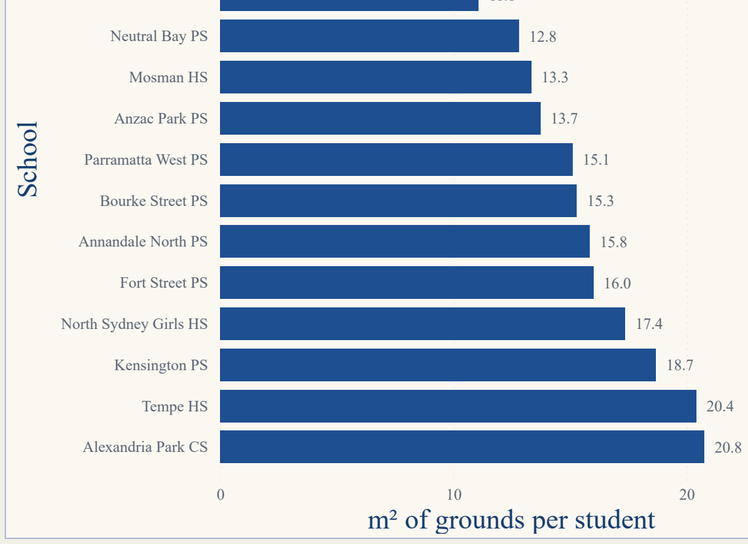
Students in the study area

41K

Median m² per student, primary schools

30.3

The 15 compared schools with the least ground per student



School data: NSW Department of Education, data.nsw.gov.au (CC BY). Cadastre and imagery: © State of New South Wales (Spatial Services), CC BY 3.0 AU. School outlines made in Plotlay (getplotlay.com) from NSW Cadastre lots and drawn over NSW Imagery. Suburbs on the map: ABS ASGS 2021 (CC BY 4.0). Grounds are land including buildings, not floor or playground area. Areas approximate.

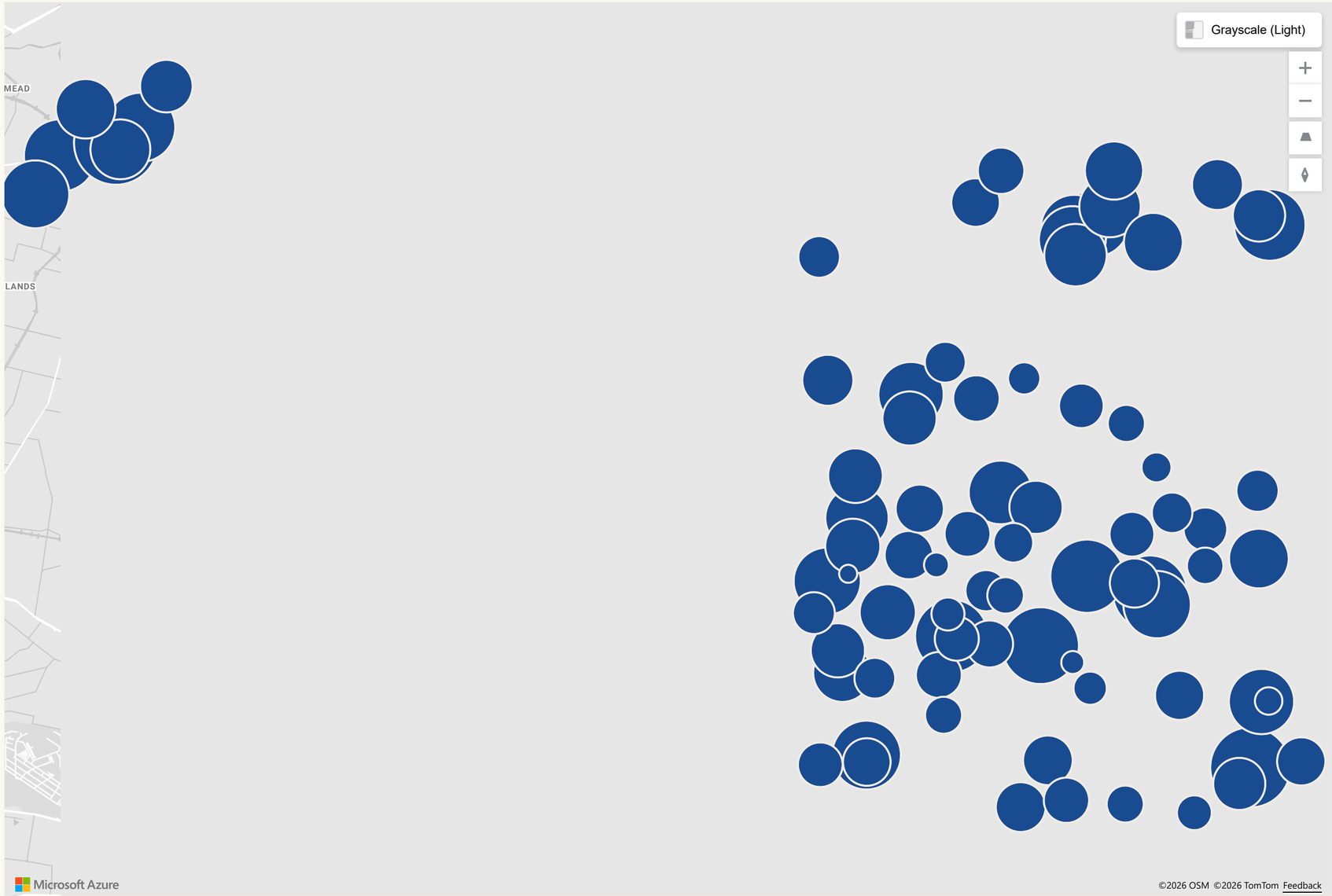
WHERE THE TIGHT SCHOOLS ARE

Azure Maps: add the reference layer data/geometry/schools.geojson (Format visual, Reference layer) for the filled shapes; it joins on the school code.

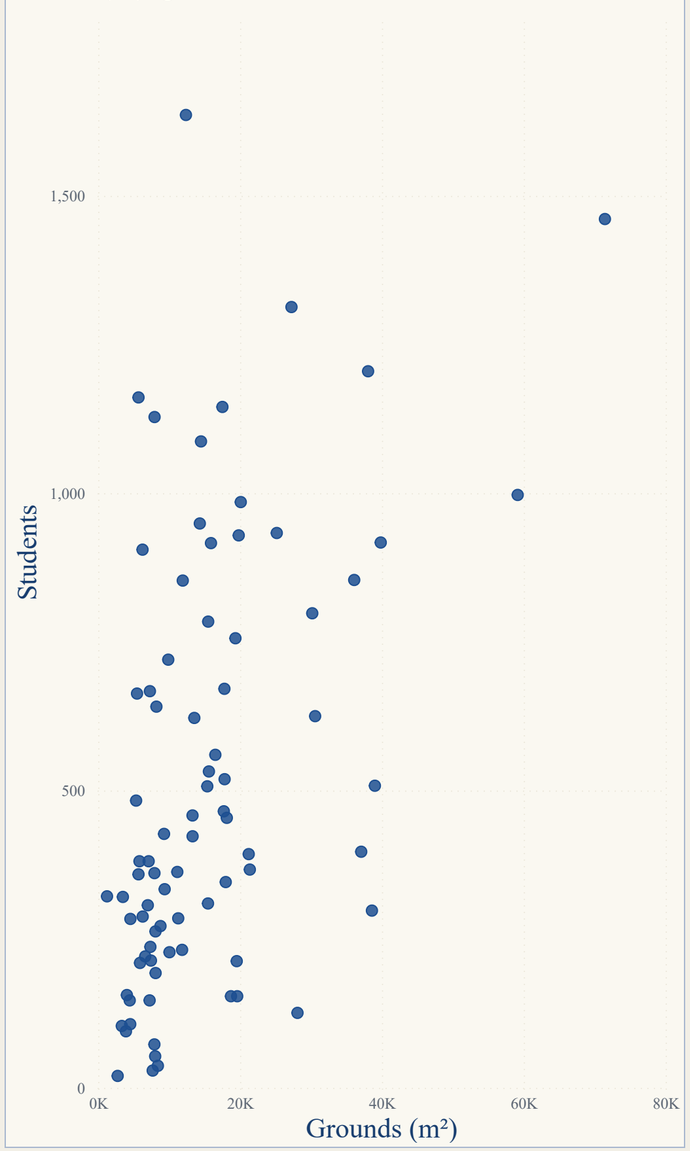
Year

2025

Schools (bubble size: students)



Grounds (m²) against students

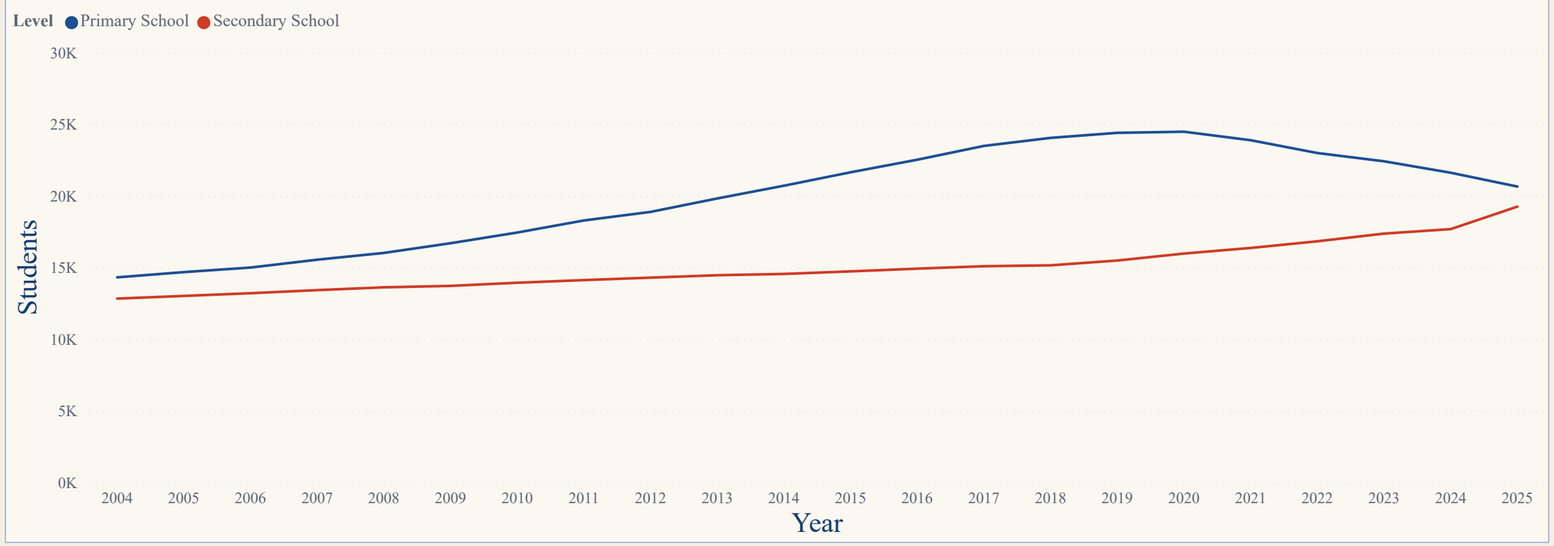


School data: NSW Department of Education, data.nsw.gov.au (CC BY). Cadastre and imagery: © State of New South Wales (Spatial Services), CC BY 3.0 AU. School outlines made in Plotlay (getplotlay.com) from NSW Cadastre lots and drawn over NSW Imagery. Suburbs on the map: ABS ASGS 2021 (CC BY 4.0). Grounds are land including buildings, not floor or playground area. Areas approximate.

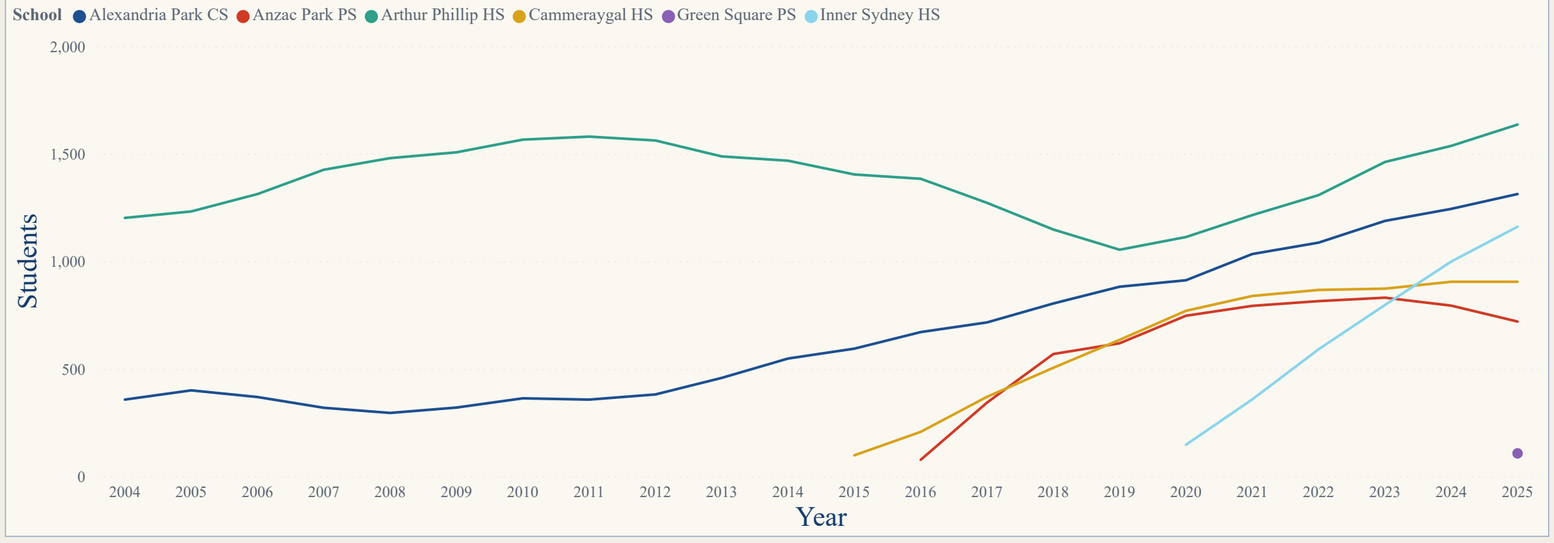
NEW SCHOOLS OPEN A YEAR GROUP AT A TIME

Headcount 2004 to 2025. New schools climb as planned year groups are added (Inner Sydney High: Year 7 in 2020, Years 7 to 12 in 2025), not from a surge in demand.

Students by level of schooling



New schools (staged openings) and rebuilt schools



Schools

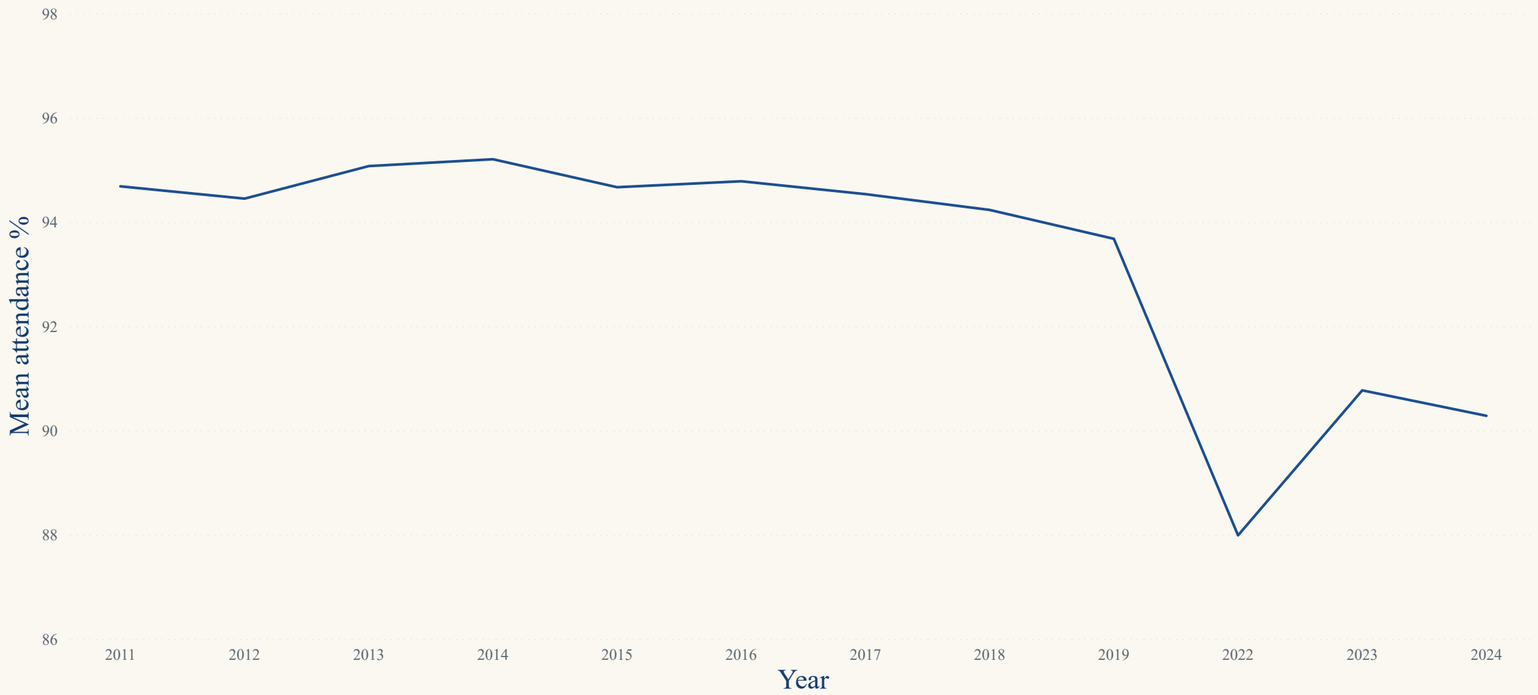
School	Students 2015	Students 2025	Growth since 2015	m² per student, 2025
Alexandria Park CS	594	1,313	121%	20.8
Annandale North PS	411	359	-13%	15.8
Annandale PS	377	363	-4%	30.7
Anzac Park PS		720		13.7
Arthur Phillip HS	1,404	1,636	17%	7.6
Australia Street Infants	129	104	-19%	32.0
Balmain PS	304	321	6%	10.9
Bayanami PS		663		8.3
Birchgrove PS	364	214	-41%	34.8
Bourke Street PS	296	381	29%	15.3
Bradfield College	348	322	-7%	3.9
Bridge Road	27	37	37%	227.5
Camdenville PS	225	310	38%	50.0
Cammeray PS	924	622	-33%	21.8
Cammeraygal HS	98	905	823%	6.9
Centennial Park	34	53	56%	151.7
Conservatorium HS	159	156	-2%	26.0
Coogee PS	609	361	-41%	22.0
Crown Street PS	280	288	3%	21.8
Daceyville PS	261	126	-52%	223.0
Darlinghurst PS	284	210	-26%	28.1
Darlington PS	238	147	-38%	49.3
Double Bay PS	368	237	-36%	31.1
Drummoyne PS	695	427	-39%	21.8
Eastlakes PS	193	154	-20%	121.6
Erskineville PS	373	334	-10%	28.1
Ferncourt PS	432	285	-34%	39.6
Forest Lodge PS	307	307	0%	22.8
Fort Street HS	941	917	-3%	43.4
Fort Street PS	157	284	81%	16.0
Gardeners Road PS	302	393	30%	54.0
Glebe PS	212	193	-9%	42.0
Glenmore Road PS	348	263	-24%	30.7
Green Square PS		107		42.3
Greenwich PS	496	367	-26%	58.3
Hunters Hill PS	377	228	-40%	44.1
Inner Sydney HS		1,161		4.9
J J Cahill Memorial HS	295	298	1%	129.5
Kensington PS	437	381	-13%	18.7
Leichhardt PS	674	532	-21%	29.3
Macarthur Girls HS	1,036	997	-4%	59.3
Marrickville HS	350	625	79%	48.9
Marrickville PS	274	213	-22%	91.7
Total	**37,248**	**41,439**	**11%**	**29.9**

School data: NSW Department of Education, data.nsw.gov.au (CC BY). Cadastre and imagery: © State of New South Wales (Spatial Services), CC BY 3.0 AU. School outlines made in Plotlay (getplotlay.com) from NSW Cadastre lots and drawn over NSW Imagery. Suburbs on the map: ABS ASGS 2021 (CC BY 4.0). Grounds are land including buildings, not floor or playground area. Areas approximate.

ATTENDANCE AFTER 2019

Semester 1 attendance. No 2020 data; the department says 2021 is not comparable.

Mean attendance, study area



Schools below their 2019 attendance in 2024

68

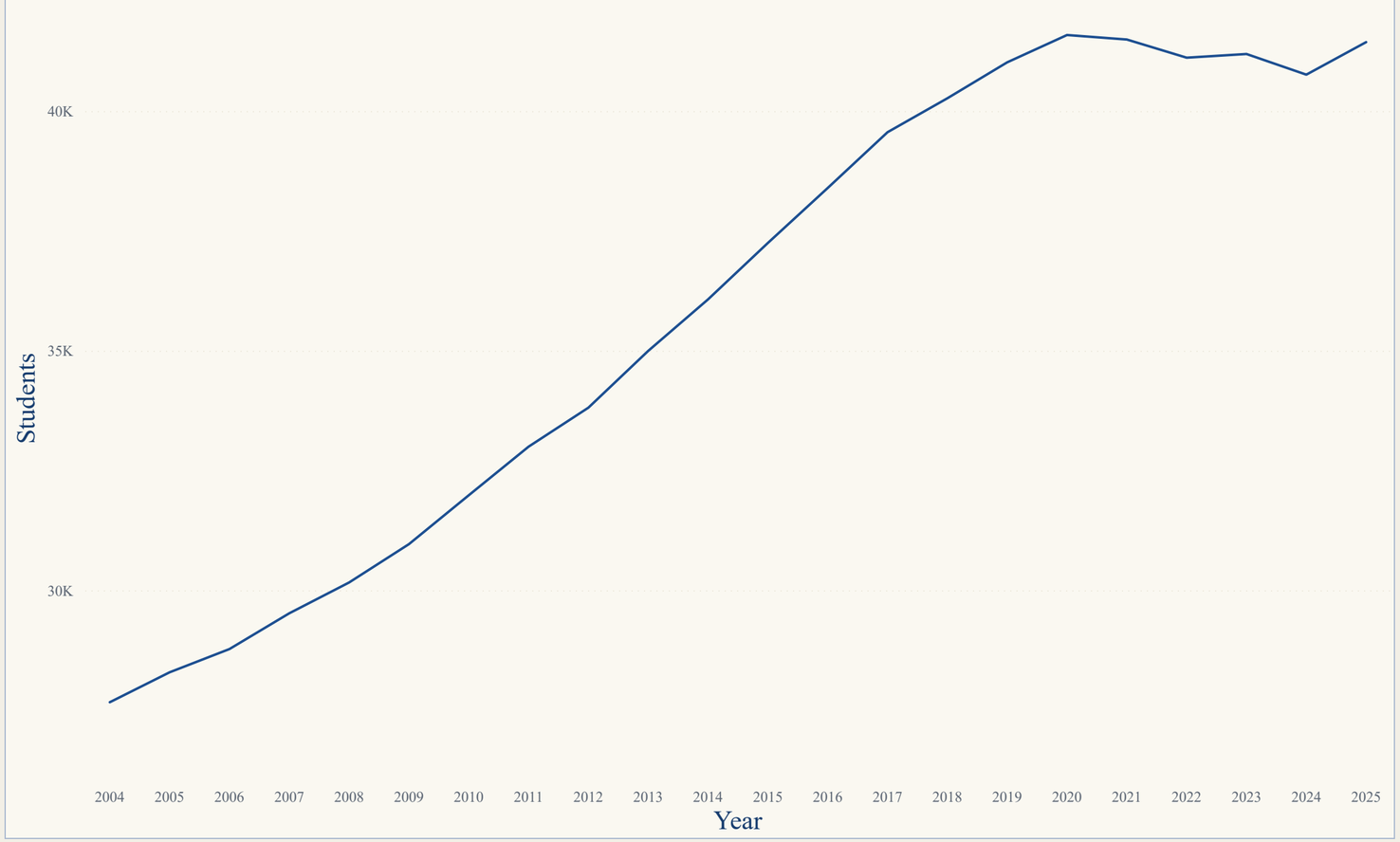
Attendance has many causes. This data shows no clear link between grounds per student and attendance.

School data: NSW Department of Education, data.nsw.gov.au (CC BY). Cadastre and imagery: © State of New South Wales (Spatial Services), CC BY 3.0 AU. School outlines made in Plotlay (getplotlay.com) from NSW Cadastre lots and drawn over NSW Imagery. Suburbs on the map: ABS ASGS 2021 (CC BY 4.0). Grounds are land including buildings, not floor or playground area. Areas approximate.

Pick a school,

m² of grounds per student, 2025	Students, 2025	Car spaces of ground per student, 2025	Attendance, 2024
29.9	41K	2.31	90.3

Students, 2004 to 2025



How the area was made

Outline from	Lots	Outline check	Grounds (m²)	Note
drawn over NSW Ima…		cant_verify	1,249	Inside the TAFE NSW St Leonards cam…
NSW Cadastre lots	7//DP32923;6//DP…	ok	2,749	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP830304	ok	3,332	
NSW Cadastre lots	651//DP729096;1/…	ok	3,484	
NSW Cadastre lots	2//DP794922;1//D…	adjusted	3,916	A 267 m² lot that does not touch the rest …
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP832310	cant_verify	4,049	Lot 1//DP832310, the Greenway buildin…
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP724267;1//D…	ok	4,449	
drawn over NSW Ima…		cant_verify	4,521	Opened 2025. Drawn over the imagery r…
NSW Cadastre lots	10//DP1256962	ok	4,544	Its lot covers the whole Observatory Hill…
NSW Cadastre lots	101//DP1105527	ok	5,349	
NSW Cadastre lots	2//DP1241622	cant_verify	5,479	Its two lots do not touch (a building bet…
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP723531;1//D…	ok	5,687	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP797483;1//D…	ok	5,687	A 14-storey vertical school (opened 202…
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP724171;1//D…	ok	5,823	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP809992	ok	5,899	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP782580	cant_verify	6,254	Lot 1//DP782580, the Years 7 to 9 camp…
NSW Cadastre lots	2//DP54079;1//DP…	ok	6,276	
NSW Cadastre lots	101//DP866098	ok	6,637	
NSW Cadastre lots	4//DP1334;5//DP1…	ok	6,998	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP914422	ok	7,119	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP1290656	ok	7,252	Its lot includes the marked playing field.
NSW Cadastre lots	5//DP795238;4//D…	ok	7,295	
NSW Cadastre lots	2//DP220568;1//D…	ok	7,362	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP123161;8//D…	ok	7,441	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP795228	ok	7,687	
NSW Cadastre lots	2//DP866026	cant_verify	7,928	Its lot (2//DP866026) is shared with the …
NSW Cadastre lots	570//DP752011;1/…	ok	7,938	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP795042	ok	7,950	
NSW Cadastre lots	11/10/DP758867	adjusted	8,039	Lot 11/10/DP758867 under its point. A s…
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP1136404	ok	8,080	
NSW Cadastre lots	3//DP830644;2//D…	ok	8,097	Three lots including the grassed block o…
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP1286471	ok	8,213	
NSW Cadastre lots	1//DP879583;2//D…	ok	8,419	

School data: NSW Department of Education, data.nsw.gov.au (CC BY). Cadastre and imagery: © State of New South Wales (Spatial Services), CC BY 3.0 AU. School outlines made in Plotlay (getplotlay.com) from NSW Cadastre lots and drawn over NSW Imagery. Suburbs on the map: ABS ASGS 2021 (CC BY 4.0). Grounds are land including buildings, not floor or playground area. Areas approximate.